

كلية المدينة العالمية
للدراستات العربية والإسلامية

Al-Madeenah International College for Arabic & Islamic Studies

THE ACADEMIC & EDITORIAL BIBLE

The academic and editorial constitution of the College

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The Academic & Editorial Bible

كلية المدينة العالمية للدراسات العربية والإسلامية

Al-Madeenah International College for Arabic & Islamic Studies

Version 1.0 · 10 August 2026 · Cited as AEB §n

The academic and editorial constitution of the College. Every page, programme, lesson, certificate, notification, announcement, assistant reply and public claim must be traceable to this document.

Standing. This Bible governs *what is taught, how it is assessed, what it is called, and what may be said about it*. It sits alongside docs/00-editorial-bible.md (EB), which governs institutional truth and conduct, and docs/09-design-excellence-bible.md (DX), which governs visual execution. Where this document and EB differ on an academic matter, this document governs. Where they differ on a matter of institutional honesty, EB §46 governs absolutely and without exception.

Document control

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Epistemic key

Every claim in this document carries one of six standings. Nothing is stated flatly that has not earned flat statement.

Mark	Meaning
[F]	Established fact — verifiable today
[I]	Founder intention — instructed by the Founder, not yet operative
[R]	Academic recommendation — my professional judgement, open to correction
[A]	Strategic assumption — a working premise that must be tested
[P]	Future possibility — deliberately not built yet
[V]	Requires external verification — legal, regulatory or scholarly

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PART I — INSTITUTIONAL EDITORIAL FOUNDATION

§1. Identity

Arabic name. كلية المدينة العالمية للدراسات العربية والإسلامية [I]

English name. Al-Madeenah International College for Arabic & Islamic Studies [I]

Short forms. *Al-Madeenah* (English) · كلية المدينة (Arabic). Never "AMICAIS" — an institution that needs an acronym has a name problem, not an abbreviation problem.

§1.1 What changed, and why it is recorded

This supersedes the previously ratified *Al-Madinah International College of Arabic and Qur'anic Studies*. Three changes, each deliberate:

Was	Is	Why
Al-Madinah	Al-Madeenah	Founder's orthography. The doubled vowel carries the long <i>ī</i> of المدينة for a reader with no Arabic, which the single <i>i</i> does not.
الدولية	العالمية	الدولية reads as <i>inter-state</i> , the register of treaties and governments. العالمية is <i>of the world</i> — the correct word for an institution whose students share no state.
of Arabic and Qur'anic Studies	for Arabic & Islamic Studies	The narrower name misdescribed the College. Qur'an is one of three schools, not the whole. The Qur'an loses nothing by being named accurately as part of a larger body.

[V] **Legal.** The registered name is a Founder and legal matter. Nothing here asserts registration. See [D-13](#).

§2. Purpose

To make serious Arabic and Islamic learning reachable by anyone with a phone and an intention, without lowering what "serious" means. [I]

§3. Vision

[I] A college without walls that a student in Lagos, London, Dakar, Riyadh or Paris enters on the same terms, studies at a pace their life permits, and leaves with a record another institution can evaluate.

§4. Mission

[I] To teach Arabic as the instrument that opens the tradition; to teach the Qur'an as something *retained* rather than merely reached; to teach the Islamic sciences from named texts with honest attribution; and to certify only what we can evidence.

§5. The educational promise

Four sentences. Every one is falsifiable, which is the point.

1. **What you are taught is fixed. When you learn it is yours.** The standard does not move because a student is fast, slow, employed, or poor.

1. **You advance because you demonstrated something, not because time passed.**

2. **You will never be charged to prove that you studied here.** Verification of your own

credential is free and permanent.

1. **The price of the education is not the price of the dignity.** Service tiers differ.

Academic standing does not.

§6. Founder principles carried forward

From the Founder's Master Roadmap, which remains the origin document of this institution and is treated as historical founder material rather than operative policy:

Principle	Standing
Affordable premium Arabic and Qur'anic education	[I] Carried forward intact
The institution must be financially sustainable, not merely enrolled	[I] Carried forward and strengthened (§6.1)
The institution must outlast its founder	[I] Carried forward; drives §59 archives
A four-month online programme, Standard/Advanced/Premium at ₦6,000/₦8,000/₦10,000	[Superseded] — see §6.1 and D-17
Separate registration, ID, certificate and transcript charges	[Superseded] — see §6.1

§6.1 The financing correction

The Roadmap's instinct — that the institution must be sustainable — was right and is retained. Its *mechanism* is corrected, on the Founder's own instruction.

Credentials will not finance the College. Charging a student to obtain evidence of their own completed education creates an incentive the institution must never hold: it makes the College better off when a graduate needs proof of their own study. That is a structural conflict, not a pricing preference.

The model is cross-subsidy [I]:

Layer	Function
Core tuition	Highly affordable. Covers direct teaching cost, not the whole institution.
Premium service tiers	Higher margin. Buys <i>service</i> , never standing (§45).
Specialist and corporate programmes	Higher margin. Subsidises core.
Optional private tutoring	Optional. Never required to pass.
Donations, waqf, endowment	Ring-fenced to the Access Fund.
Administrative credential services	Transparent cost recovery only. Never a margin line.

Binding rule. The first issue of every certificate and every transcript is free. Only *replacement, expedited handling* and *physical production and postage* may be charged, at documented cost. Verification is free forever, to everyone. [I]

Full unit economics belong to the *Institutional Master Plan*, the next document in sequence (§65). This Bible fixes the principles that model must satisfy.

§7. Institutional values

Ṣīdīq (صدق) — truthfulness in every claim, including the unflattering ones. **Itqān** (إتقان) — mastery as a standard, not a slogan. **Amānah** (أمانة) — a student's record is a trust we hold, not data we own. **ʿAdl** (عدل) — the same standard for the sponsored student and the paying one. **Hilm** (حلم) — patience with a slow learner is a competence, not a courtesy.

§8. Islamic ethical principles

1. The Qur'an is never an illustration. It is never decoration, never a background texture, never cropped for composition. **[Binding]**

1. The College issues no fatwā and takes no position in recognised scholarly disagreement. It teaches the disagreement. **[Binding]** (**EB §5**)

1. Recognised differences among the schools are taught respectfully and attributed, never adjudicated. **[Binding]**

1. No teaching is presented as more authoritative than its evidence.

2. Ribā-free finance in every instalment arrangement the College offers. **[I]**

§9. Academic integrity

Integrity is symmetrical: it binds the institution before it binds the student.

On the institution: we do not award what we cannot assess; we do not name a level we cannot define; we do not describe a pathway we have never run as though we had.

On the student: work submitted is the student's own; assistance is declared; impersonation in an assessment voids the attempt and is recorded permanently.

On the assistant: **§34** .

§10. The institutional honesty protocol

EB §46 is imported whole and is not subordinate to any provision of this Bible.

Its operative consequence for academic writing: **no page may describe a thing the College has not done as though it had done it**. We have admitted no students. Therefore no graduation figure, no completion rate, no testimonial, no "our students", no alumni claim, and no faculty biography may appear until each is true and dated. Where a page needs to describe a capability we have built but not yet used, it says so in those words.

§11. International positioning

[I] African in origin, Madinan in spirit, international in reach. Stated in that order, because the order is the truth. The College does not present its African origin as something to be managed. It is the reason the institution understands what affordability and bandwidth actually cost.

§12. Distance learning is the institution

[I][Binding] Al-Madeenah is a fully distance-learning college. This is not a delivery mode attached to a college; it is the college.

Therefore, throughout this Bible and every system built under it:

A conventional college has	Al-Madeenah has
Campus buildings	Nothing. The word "campus" does not appear on a public surface.
Classrooms	Live sessions, time-zone scheduled (§27)
A library building	The Digital Library (§31)
A registrar's counter	The Registry (§39)
Notice boards	Student notifications (§53)
An examinations hall	Supervised distance assessment (§36)
A certificates office	Digital credential of record + optional printed expression (§38)
Physical student ID	The credential register entry. The card, if ever produced, is a souvenir.

The College does not apologise for being online, and does not market being online as a concession. It is not "an alternative to the real college." It is the model, chosen because it is the only one that reaches the student this institution exists for.

PART II — ACADEMIC PHILOSOPHY

§13. What education is for, here

Four outcomes, ranked. When they conflict, the higher governs.

1. **Access to the tradition.** A graduate can open a classical text and make progress in it without a translator standing between them and it.

1. **Retention.** What was learned is still there a year later. An education that evaporates was not an education.

1. **Character (adab).** The manner of seeking knowledge is part of the knowledge.

2. **Independence.** The graduate can continue without us. An institution that makes itself necessary forever has failed.

§14. The governing formula

Fixed standards + flexible pace + mastery-based progression + differentiated service.

Each clause carries weight, and each constrains the others:

- **Fixed standards** — the syllabus, the gates and the evidence required are identical for every student on every pathway and at every price.
- **Flexible pace** — the *calendar* is the student's. Employment, family, Ramadan, travel and bandwidth are real, and an institution that ignores them is not serious about access.
- **Mastery-based progression** — the student advances on demonstrated competence.
- **Differentiated service** — money buys attention, convenience and access to more teaching. It never buys a grade, a gate, a level or a credential.

§15. Why mastery, and what it costs us

Time-based progression fails in both directions: it graduates a student who paid for nine months and learned little, and it holds back a student who mastered the material in three. Both are injustices, and the second is the one poor students suffer most, because they cannot afford to buy time they do not need.

What mastery costs the College, stated plainly: unpredictable revenue timing, higher assessment load, and the operational difficulty of a cohort whose members are at different points. These are accepted. They are the price of the claim.

§16. Mastery defined

A student has demonstrated mastery of a unit when, **assessed by a qualified human**, they can perform its stated competencies **to the stated criterion, on demand, without notice, after an interval**.

Five clauses, and every one is load-bearing:

Clause	What it excludes
Assessed by a qualified human	An auto-marked quiz alone can never constitute a gate
Stated competencies	"Did the coursework"
To the stated criterion	A pass mark set after the fact
On demand	A rehearsed performance
Without notice, after an interval	Cramming — the thing that makes ḥifẓ evaporate

§16.1 The Retention Rule

****A portion of the Qur'an, or a competency in Arabic, counts as *held* only if it survives unannounced re-testing after a defined interval.**** Most institutions record what a student *reached*. Al-Madeenah records what a student *retains*.

[Binding]

This is the single strongest academic claim the College makes, and it is the one most easily faked. It is therefore the one most tightly evidenced: every retention test is timestamped, recorded, and attributable to a named assessor in the student record (§40).

§17. What a failed gate means

A failed gate is a diagnostic, not a verdict. It produces a specific statement of what was missing and a targeted remediation plan.

Retakes are unlimited and free. [Binding] A College that charges for a retake has made a student's difficulty into a revenue line, and has given itself a reason to prefer failure. There is no version of that which survives §9 .

§18. What the College will not claim

It will not claim that distance learning is equivalent to sitting with a teacher. It is not. It is *reachable*, which for the great majority of our students is the difference between this education and no education at all. That is a sufficient claim and it has the advantage of being true.

PART III — THE ACADEMIC ARCHITECTURE

§19. Levels are not durations

[R][Binding] This resolves the central ambiguity in the founding material.

A *level* is a defined body of competence, measured in **notional learning hours (NLH)** and gated by demonstrated mastery. A *duration* is what happens when a particular student applies a particular weekly pace to that body. **The level is fixed. The months are an output.**

The Founder's working figure — *Level 100* $\approx$ *two months* — is **arithmetically correct as one of four pathways**, and the modelling below shows exactly which one. It was never wrong; it was a pace being read as a definition.

§19.1 The unit: notional learning hours

1 NLH = one hour of a typical student's total effort — live sessions, recorded lessons, reading, drill, memorisation, murāja 'ah, assignments and assessment combined.

NLH is used rather than "credits" deliberately. *Credit unit*, *credit hour* and *semester hour* carry defined regulatory meanings in Nigeria and elsewhere, and using them would imply a recognition the College does not hold (§62). NLH states the same information without borrowing an authority we have not earned.

[V] **Comparability note, not an equivalence claim.** European Credit Transfer System practice treats 1 ECTS as 25–30 notional hours. A reader may divide our NLH figures by 25 to obtain an indicative comparison. This is offered so a foreign registrar can orient themselves. It is **not** a claim of ECTS recognition, and no College surface may present it as one.

§20. The Arabic ladder

Four levels. The hours are derived, not chosen — the derivation is in §20.2 so that any reviewer can check it.

Level	Arabic	NLH	Cumulative	Indicative CEFR [V]
100 Foundation	التمهيدى	200	200	~A1
200 Intermediate	المتوسط	300	500	~A2
300 Advanced	المتقدم	450	950	~B1
400 Mastery	الإتقان	600	1,550	~B2, weighted to the written and classical register

These are internal academic levels. They are not a degree, not degree-equivalent, and carry no implication of one, unless and until an accreditation framework says otherwise (§62). The numbering follows familiar convention only so that a student and a foreign registrar can read the ladder at a glance.

§20.1 What each level actually means

Level	The student can, on demand
100	Read fully vowelled Arabic aloud accurately; hold a simple exchange about themselves and daily matters; write short vowelled sentences; recognise the three-letter root and the basic ismiyyah/fi'liyyah distinction.
200	Read unvowelled simple prose with a lexicon; sustain conversation on familiar topics; write a connected paragraph; perform i'rāb on a simple sentence; recognise the common ṣarf patterns.
300	Read graded classical text with a lexicon and derive meaning independently; follow a lecture delivered in Arabic; write structured expository prose; handle the major naḥw chapters; begin balāghah.
400	Read unedited classical text in the disciplines studied; follow and take part in scholarly discourse; write academic Arabic; translate accurately in both directions; use the classical lexica (Lisān, Qāmūs) as working tools.

§20.2 Where the hours come from

Published guided-learning-hour ranges for the Common European Framework describe roughly **500–600 cumulative hours to B2** for a *Category I* language (French, Spanish) for an English-speaking learner. The United States Foreign Service Institute classifies Arabic as **Category IV — "super-hard"**, requiring on the order of **2,200 class hours** to reach professional working proficiency against roughly **600–750** for Category I: a multiplier in the region of **2.6–3.0×**.

Applying the lower, more conservative end of that multiplier to the B2 figure:

$$500\text{--}600 \text{ hours} \times 2.6 \approx \mathbf{1,300\text{--}1,560 \text{ NLH}}$$

Our cumulative figure to Level 400 is **1,550 NLH**. The ladder is calibrated to the conservative end of published Arabic difficulty research rather than to a number that would make the programme look faster. [V] — **the calibration should be reviewed against our own first-cohort completion data once it exists, and revised if the data disagrees.**

Why Level 400 is scoped to the written and classical register. Full FSI-style professional proficiency includes dialectal fluency and negotiation-level speech, which this College does not teach and should not imply. Our terminal target is *access to the tradition in writing and scholarly speech*. Narrower, honestly stated, and achievable.

§20.3 Pace, and the resolution of the two-month question

Pathway	Weekly commitment	Level 100 (200 NLH)	Level 200 (300 NLH)	Full ladder (1,550 NLH)
Accelerated	~25 h	8 weeks ≈ 2 months	12 weeks ≈ 3 months	~62 weeks ≈ 1 yr 3 mo
Intensive	~15 h	13 weeks ≈ 3 months	20 weeks ≈ 5 months	~103 weeks ≈ 2 yrs
Regular	~8 h	25 weeks ≈ 6 months	38 weeks ≈ 9 months	~194 weeks ≈ 3 yrs 9 mo
Flexible	~4 h	50 weeks ≈ 12 months	75 weeks ≈ 17 months	capped — see §22

The Founder's figure is confirmed. Level 100 in two months is exactly right *at the accelerated pace of about twenty-five hours a week* — roughly a full-time commitment. It is a real pathway and the College will offer it. What it is not is the definition of the level, and it is not what a working adult with children should be sold.

Accelerated is not a discount on the syllabus. Identical hours, identical gates, identical evidence — compressed into fewer weeks. §21 makes that binding.

§21. The equal-standard rule

[Binding] Across every pathway of a given programme, these are identical: total NLH, learning outcomes, assessment instruments, mastery criteria, and the wording of the credential awarded. **Only the calendar differs.**

A pathway may never be created by removing content. If a route cannot carry the full hours, it is not a faster route — it is a different, shorter programme, and it must be named and credentialed as one.

§22. Flexibility without chaos

Flexibility that never ends is not flexibility; it is an abandoned enrolment that the institution has not had the honesty to close. Every programme therefore carries:

Rule	Value
Minimum sustained pace	3 NLH/week averaged over any 8-week window
Maximum registration period	2.5 × the regular-pathway duration
Approved leave	Up to 12 months, in blocks, on request, without penalty — the clock stops
Dormancy	16 weeks below minimum pace with no approved leave → contact, then dormant status
Re-entry	Permitted. Assessed for currency; mastery already demonstrated is not re-tested unless the interval makes it unsafe
Lapse	At maximum registration, the enrolment closes and a Statement of Results is issued for what <i>was</i> completed

A student who runs out of time still receives a truthful record of what they achieved. Nothing is confiscated for lateness.

§23. The school ladder — and a correction

The classical stages **Ibtidā'iyyah**, **I'dādiyyah** and **Thanawiyyah** are carried forward. But the Mandate's proposal — regular 3 years, intensive 2, accelerated 1, for all three — contains a problem I am obliged to raise rather than implement.

§23.1 The problem

These three names do not denote only a body of knowledge. In Nigeria and across the Arabic-Islamic education world they denote **school stages** — primary, preparatory and secondary — and secondary-stage certification is examined and awarded by external bodies. In Nigeria the relevant body is the **National Board for Arabic and Islamic Studies (NBAIS)**. **[F]** Such bodies characteristically specify minimum attendance duration for a school-leaving award, precisely because a school-leaving certificate makes a claim about a period of formation, not only about knowledge held. **[V]** — **NBAIS's current requirements must be confirmed directly; nothing here should be relied on as a statement of them.**

A one-year "accelerated Thanawiyyah" offered to a sixteen-year-old as a school-leaving qualification would therefore be, at best, unrecognised, and at worst a misrepresentation. **§9 does not permit us to sell it.**

§23.2 The correction: two routes, named differently

	Academic Route	Certificated School Route
For	Adults and independent learners seeking the knowledge	Candidates seeking an externally recognised school-stage certificate
Paces	All four, including accelerated	The external body's duration rules govern
Gated by	Al-Madeenah mastery gates	External syllabus and external examination
Award	Al-Madeenah Certificate of Mastery, stage-named	The external award, with an Al-Madeenah record of preparation
Status	[I] Buildable now	[V] Blocked pending D-14

This preserves the Founder's flexibility for the people it was meant for — adults returning to serious study, who are the majority of a distance institution's intake — and withholds it only where an external body's rules, not ours, are the binding constraint.

§23.3 The stages

Stage	Arabic	NLH	Regular	Intensive	Accelerated
Ibtidā' iyyah	الابتدائية	960	3 yrs @ ~8 h/wk	2 yrs @ ~12 h/wk	1 yr @ ~24 h/wk
I'dādiyyah	الإعدادية	1,080	3 yrs @ ~9 h/wk	2 yrs @ ~14 h/wk	1 yr @ ~27 h/wk
Thanawīyyah	الثانوية	1,200	3 yrs @ ~10 h/wk	2 yrs @ ~15 h/wk	1 yr @ ~30 h/wk

Computed on a 40-week teaching year. The accelerated column is a genuine full-time commitment and is described as such wherever it is offered; it is available on the Academic Route only (**§23.2**).

§24. The Qur'an ladder

Memorisation is not measured in hours; it is measured in **portions retained**. Hours are recorded for planning and for the transcript's learning-volume column, not as the standard.

Unit	Definition
Portion	One juz' (جزء)
Indicative volume	60–80 NLH per juz' <i>including</i> murāja'ah to criterion [R]
Full Qur'an	30 portions ≈ 1,800–2,400 NLH
Standard	Itqān grade + the Retention Rule (§16.1)

The Qur'an ladder runs independently of the Arabic ladder and a student may be at Level 200 Arabic and hold twelve portions, or the reverse. Forcing them into one sequence would be an administrative convenience purchased with academic sense.

[Binding] No ijāzah. **§37**.

PART IV — CURRICULUM

§25. What earns a place

[**Binding**] A subject enters the curriculum only if it passes all four tests:

1. **Necessity** — a graduate who lacks it cannot meet the level's stated outcomes.
2. **Teachability at distance** — we can actually teach and assess it remotely, well.
3. **Assessability** — we can evidence it. A subject we cannot assess is a subject we

cannot certify, and therefore a subject we should not charge for.

1. **Capacity** — a qualified teacher exists, or can be appointed, to teach it.

A subject that fails any test is an **elective**, a **future possibility**, or absent. It is never included to make the catalogue look substantial. §64.

§26. The three schools

§26.1 School of Arabic Language — كلية اللغة العربية

Core (every student, every level)	Elective / later level
Reading (القراءة)	Literature (الأدب) — L300+
Writing (الكتابة)	Balāghah (البلاغة) — L300+
Listening (الاستماع)	Translation (الترجمة) — L300+
Speaking & conversation (المحادثة)	Academic Arabic (العربية الأكاديمية) — L400
Vocabulary (المفردات)	Research skills (مهارات البحث) — L400
Nahw (النحو)	Dictation (الإملاء) — folded into Writing, not standalone
Sarf (الصرف)	
Composition (الإنشاء)	
Qur'anic & classical register (العربية القرآنية والتراثية) — from L200	

Decision recorded: *Dictation* does not survive §25.1 as a standalone subject at distance; it is an assessment instrument within Writing. *Classical Arabic*, *Qur'anic Arabic* and *Hadith Arabic* are not three subjects — they are one competence, **the classical register**, taught with texts drawn from all three sources. Listing them separately would triple the catalogue and teach nothing extra.

Assessed across five modalities at every level: reading, listening, speaking, writing, and comprehension of classical text. The fifth is where conversational programmes have nothing to offer, and it is not optional here.

§26.2 School of the Qur'an — كلية القرآن

Core	Elective / later
Nazrah (النظرة) — accurate reading from the muṣḥaf	Qur'anic vocabulary (مفردات القرآن)
Tajwīd theory (التجويد)	Waqf and Ibtidā' (الوقف والابتداء) — advanced
Makhārij and Sifāt (المخارج والصفات)	
Recitation to criterion (التلاوة)	
Ḥifẓ (الحفظ)	
Murāja'ah (المراجعة) — compulsory, scheduled, never optional	

Murāja'ah is the stage most institutions skip and the one most responsible for ḥifẓ loss. Here it is compulsory and system-scheduled (§29.1).

[V] The riwāyah must be declared. Every Qur'an credential states the riwāyah in which it was assessed. Until the Founder and a qualified muqri' settle this, no Qur'an award may be issued. D-06 .

§26.3 School of Islamic Sciences — كلية العلوم الشرعية

Core	Elective / later	Deliberately excluded now
'Aqīdah (العقيدة)	Uṣūl al-fiqh (أصول الفقه) — advanced	Fatwā, in any form
Fiqh al-'ibādāt (فقه العبادات)	Muṣṭalaḥ al-ḥadīth (مصطلح الحديث) — advanced	Contemporary rulings
Sīrah (السيرة)	Islamic history (التاريخ الإسلامي)	Comparative polemics
Ḥadīth — named collections, with attribution	Tafsīr (التفسير) — from L300, never before the Arabic supports it	
Adab and akhlāq (الآداب والأخلاق)		

Tafsīr is gated behind Level 300 Arabic [R] — deliberately, and at the cost of enrolment. Tafsīr taught in translation to a student who cannot read the āyah is not tafsīr; it is a summary of someone else's tafsīr. The College will not describe that as the study of Qur'anic exegesis.

"**Contemporary issues**" is excluded from the core because the honest version of it is fatwā-adjacent and §8.2 forbids the College a position. It may return as a *seminar series with named external scholars speaking in their own names*. [P]

§27. Distance pedagogy

[Binding] We do not film a classroom. The two modes are designed against each other, not stacked.

Live (synchronous) — for what needs a human in the moment	Flexible (asynchronous) — for what needs repetition
Recitation and correction	Recorded lessons
Speaking and pronunciation	Reading and text study
Oral assessment and gates	Drill and exercises
Tutorials, difficulty, error diagnosis	Vocabulary and murāja‘ah
Office hours, advising	Assignments, quizzes
Seminars	Independent study

The allocation rule: if a competent adult could acquire it alone with good materials, it is asynchronous. Live time is scarce and expensive, and it is reserved for what only a teacher can do — *bear the error and name it*.

§27.1 Time-zone architecture

[Binding] Student local time $\neq$ institution time $\neq$ teacher time. Every time displayed to a student is rendered in that student's own timezone, always, with no exception and no setting to get wrong.

One course. Multiple scheduled **sections** where demand justifies it — West Africa, Europe, Gulf, Americas. Not multiple courses, not multiple systems, not different syllabi. §64 .

No live session is scheduled across a student section's local Maghrib window. [I]

§27.2 The mobile and bandwidth covenant

EB §48 is imported. Its academic consequences are binding on curriculum design, not only on the interface:

1. **Audio-first is a design default, not a fallback.** Recitation, dictation, listening

and vocabulary drill are authored as audio that stands alone. Video is an enhancement.

1. **Every lesson has a downloadable form** that works with the connection off.
2. **No assessment may require sustained live video.** Where video is genuinely required

— identity confirmation, some oral gates — it is a *short*, scheduled, low-resolution segment, with an audio-only fallback path recorded as an approved accommodation.

1. **Total weight of a lesson's required assets is budgeted and published** to the

student in megabytes before they open it. Data costs money. Pretending otherwise is a design decision made by someone who has never paid for it.

1. **Progress survives interruption.** A dropped connection never costs submitted work.

§28. The course design standard

[Binding] No course enters the catalogue without every field completed:

Field	Rule
Course code	SCHOOL-LEVEL-NN , e.g. ARB-100-03 . Permanent; never reused.
Arabic title	Authored in Arabic (§48), not translated
English title	Authored in English
Level	The ladder position
Prerequisites	Named courses or a placement outcome
Description	60 words maximum
Learning outcomes	4–8, each beginning with an observable verb. Never "understand".
Notional learning hours	Broken into contact / independent / assessment
Weekly structure	What a typical week contains
Assessments	Instrument, weighting, formative or summative
Mastery criteria	The exact standard for the gate, published in advance
Recommended pace	Per pathway
Transcript representation	Exactly how it appears on the record

Learning outcomes may not use the verbs "understand", "know", "appreciate" or "be familiar with". None of them can be observed, and an outcome that cannot be observed cannot be assessed, which means it cannot be a gate.

§29. Institutional learning methods

[R] The Mandate invites signature methodologies. Restraint applies: a method earns a name only when the *name itself* is what a student uses to recall the discipline. Three qualify. The rest are taught under their classical names, because a 1,200-year-old discipline does not need our branding, and dressing i‘rāb in a new acronym would be the opposite of scholarly.

§29.1 The Five Returns — المراجعات الخمس

The classical ḥifẓ cycle already distinguishes **sabaq** (today's new portion), **sabqi** (recently memorised, still fragile) and **manzil** (the consolidated corpus). The weakness in practice is that *sabqi* is left to the student's discretion, and that is where memorisation is lost.

The Five Returns fixes the *sabqi* phase to an expanding retrieval schedule:

Return	Interval after first mastery
First	1 day
Second	3 days
Third	7 days
Fourth	21 days
Fifth	60 days

A portion that survives all five joins the **manzil** — the perpetual cycle — and is thereafter sampled without notice under §16.1. A portion that fails any return re-enters at the first.

Expanding intervals are used rather than fixed ones because retrieval that is *just* hard enough is what consolidates memory; a portion reviewed while still effortless teaches the student very little. The schedule is generated by the system, not left to intention.

§29.2 Root Families — الأسر الجذرية

Arabic is a root language, and vocabulary taught as an alphabetical list fights that structure instead of using it. Vocabulary is introduced by **triliteral root family**: the root, its common derived forms, the pattern that produces each, and the semantic thread connecting them. A student who has met ب-ت-ك as a family has not learned one word; they have learned a mechanism that will recognise the next forty.

§29.3 The Retention Rule

§16.1 . Named because it is the standard, and a standard that is not named is not enforced.

PART V — ASSESSMENT

§30. Assessment philosophy

The sequence is **learn** → **practise** → **assess** → **demonstrate** → **progress**, and the last two are separate on purpose. *Assessment* is frequent, cheap, and often automatic; it tells a student where they are. *Demonstration* is a gate: infrequent, human, unannounced, and recorded.

[Binding] An automatically marked instrument may never constitute a mastery gate. It may inform one. It may never be one.

§31. The instruments

Instrument	Purpose	Marked by	Gate?
Diagnostic / placement	Where to start	System + human review	No
Quiz	Retrieval practice	Auto	No
Assignment	Application	Teacher	No
Written examination	Consolidated knowledge	Teacher, moderated	Yes
Oral examination	Speaking, reasoning, i‘rāb	Teacher, live	Yes
Recitation assessment	Tajwid, accuracy, fluency	Qualified assessor, live	Yes
Memorisation check	Hifẓ and retention	Qualified assessor, unannounced	Yes
Listening / reading test	Receptive competence	Auto + human review	Contributory
Project	Extended independent work	Teacher, moderated	L300+ only

§32. Placement

Free, untimed, resumable, unlimited retakes, and **never presented as a score**. It exists to answer the question that stops most people applying — *where would I even start, and will I be embarrassed?* An instrument that answers that question with a mark has failed at its only job.

§33. Integrity at distance

Distance assessment has a real vulnerability and pretending otherwise would fail §9. The College's answer is **design, not surveillance**:

1. **Weight the gates toward live oral assessment**, which is the hardest thing in education to fake and the easiest thing to do well remotely.
1. **Identity is confirmed at the gate**, by a human who has taught or assessed the student before.
1. **Unannounced re-testing** (§16.1) makes a bought performance worthless, because it would have to be bought repeatedly and indefinitely.

1. **Question banks rotate**; no gate uses a fixed paper.

2. **No invasive proctoring software.** [Binding] No webcam-monitoring, no

screen-recording, no keystroke analysis, no browser lockdown. These fail disproportionately on cheap devices and poor connections — they would punish exactly the students this College exists for — and they buy less integrity than a five-minute oral does.

§34. Moderation and appeal

Moderation. Every summative gate is sampled — minimum 10% or five scripts, whichever is greater — by a second qualified assessor. Disagreement beyond one band triggers full re-marking of the cohort.

Appeal. A student may appeal any gate outcome within 21 days. The appeal is heard by someone who was not involved in the original decision. **Appeals are free.** The outcome is written, reasoned, and recorded. A student may not appeal *academic judgement* alone — they may appeal procedure, evidence, bias, and the application of published criteria.

§35. Grading

[R] A four-band criterion-referenced scale, published with descriptors before the assessment, and never norm-referenced:

Band	Arabic	Meaning
Itqān	إتقان	Mastery, comfortably and consistently
Jayyid	جيد	Meets the standard
Maqbūl	مقبول	Meets the minimum; specific weaknesses named
Lam yablugh	لم يبلغ	Not yet — with a diagnostic and a plan (§17)

Never a percentage on a certificate. A percentage implies a precision that human assessment of language and recitation does not have, and invites comparison between students, which §14 exists to prevent.

§36. Supervised distance assessment

Where a gate requires supervision it is scheduled, live, human, and short. The supervisor is a member of the College.

[Binding] The College will not require a student to travel to a physical centre, because §12 would be a lie if it did.

PART VI — CREDENTIALS AND TRANSCRIPTS

§37. The credential vocabulary

[Binding] These terms, and no others:

Credential	Attests to	Requires
Certificate of Completion	A defined programme was completed	Attendance and submission. Explicitly makes no mastery claim
Certificate of Mastery	Named competencies demonstrated to criterion	All gates passed
Arabic Level Award	A named level of the ladder, across all five modalities	Level gate
Qur'an Memorisation Certificate	A stated portion memorised and retained to a stated itqān grade, in a stated riwāyah	Live recitation + retention testing
Tajwid Proficiency Certificate	Command of the rules in the declared riwāyah	Live recitation
Statement of Results	What was completed, whatever the outcome	Issued on request, always, including on lapse
Academic Transcript	The complete record	Issued on request, always

§37.1 Forbidden terminology

[Binding][V] The words **Diploma**, **Degree**, **Bachelor**, **Master**, **Doctorate**, **Undergraduate**, **Postgraduate**, **Faculty of** (in the legal sense), and **University** do not appear on any Al-Madeenah credential, page, advertisement or assistant reply, in any language, until legal advice confirms the College may use each specific term in each specific market. Arabic equivalents — دبلوم, ماجستير, بكالوريوس, جامعة — are covered by the same prohibition. **D-03**.

The Arabic ladder's fourth level is called **Mastery** — إتيقان — a description of attainment, not a borrowed academic rank. The distinction is deliberate and must be preserved in translation.

§37.2 Ijāzah

[Binding] The College does not grant ijāzah. Every Qur'an credential states on its face that it is not an ijāzah and confers no chain of transmission. Students seeking one are told plainly that we do not offer it and are referred onward.

Ijāzah becomes possible only when **all** of the following are true and evidenced: qualified **muqri' ūn** are appointed; their own asānīd are verified by a competent authority; the riwāyah is declared; an assessment methodology exists in writing; and scholarly governance is constituted to oversee it. Until every one holds, the word does not appear. **D-06**.

§38. What every credential must state

Name of holder · credential type · programme · level · **notional learning hours** · competencies attested · riwāyah where applicable · grade band · date of award · **unique credential ID** · the verification URL · and — where relevant — **an explicit statement of what the credential does *not* certify.**

The last field is unusual and deliberate. A credential that is silent about its limits invites the reader to assume the maximum.

§39. The transcript standard

A transcript is not a list of grades; it is a document a stranger must be able to evaluate. Every Al-Madeenah transcript carries:

Institution block (legal name, registration standing as it truly is, contact, verification URL) · student identity and reference · programme and pathway · **for each course**: code, Arabic title, English title, level, NLH, grade band, attempts, date · cumulative NLH · **the grade scale printed on the document itself** · progression status · completion status · issue date · credential ID · verification URL.

The grade scale is printed on every transcript. A registrar in Riyadh or Toronto cannot look up a scale they have never encountered, and a transcript that assumes they can is a transcript that will be set aside.

§40. The register is the credential

[Binding] The paper *expresses* the credential. The **public verification register** *is* the credential.

The register is deliberately separate, deliberately dull, and deliberately permanent. It takes a credential ID and returns: whether it is valid, what it attests, to whom, when issued, and whether it has been revoked. Nothing else. It carries no marketing, requires no account, and is free to everyone forever (§6.1). It is the last thing that should ever be switched off, and it is designed so that it could outlive the rest of the institution.

§41. The student record

The student sees simplicity; the institution keeps depth. The record holds: identity, enrolment, programmes, courses, levels, every attempt, grades, attendance at live sessions, NLH accrued, assessment artefacts, gate outcomes with named assessors, progression decisions, credentials issued, payments, scholarships, accommodations, academic-integrity findings, and every change with who made it and when.

Amānah (§7). The record is a trust held on the student's behalf. It is not a marketing asset, it is not sold, it is not mined, and it is retained under **EB** privacy provisions with one carve-out: **the credential register entry is permanent**, because a credential that can be deleted cannot be verified.

PART VII — ISLAMIC EDITORIAL STANDARDS AND AI GOVERNANCE

§42. Sacred text

[Binding] The system may retrieve Qur'anic text from a verified source. It may never generate it. (EB §5.7) This applies to every surface without exception: lessons, assessments, the assistant, notifications, marketing, and the certificate.

Rule	
Qur'an is quoted from a single verified digital muṣḥaf of record, cited by sūrah and āyah	[Binding]
Qur'anic text is never cropped, overlaid, faded, animated, or used as a background	[Binding]
Ḥadīth is quoted with collection, book and number, and its grading where the collection provides one	[Binding]
Translation is always labelled as translation, with the translator named	[Binding]
ﷺ follows the Prophet's name in full, never as "PBUH" or "SAW"	[Binding]
رضي الله عنه / رحمه الله for Companions; رحمه الله for deceased scholars	[Binding]
Transliteration follows one published scheme, applied consistently, with full diacritics	§49
Hijrī and Gregorian dates both, Hijrī first in Arabic surfaces	§49

§43. Attribution

No scholarly position is stated without a named source. No opinion is attributed to a school without naming the work. Where scholars differ, the difference is presented as a difference, with representative positions attributed, and **the College does not adjudicate** (§8.3).

§44. AI governance

The College may offer a study assistant. [P] Its constitution is fixed here in advance, before it exists, because governance written after a system ships is not governance.

§44.1 Permitted

Explaining grammar and morphology · generating practice exercises and drills · vocabulary work · conversational practice · study planning and pacing · explaining a lesson already authored by a teacher · summarising the student's own progress · answering questions about how the College works.

§44.2 Forbidden — absolutely

[Binding]

1. **Generating, completing, correcting or reciting Qur'anic text.** It may retrieve and display verified text. It may not produce a single word of it.

1. **Generating ḥadīth**, or supplying a chain, grading or attribution not present in the retrieved source.

1. **Issuing fatwā**, or answering any question of the form "*is it permissible...*", "*" must I...", "is my 'ibādah valid..."*. It states that the College does not issue fatwā, and refers on.

1. **Presenting itself as a scholar, muftī, shaykh, muqri' or teacher.** It is a study assistant and says so when asked.

1. **Assessing, grading, or contributing to a mastery gate.** §30 .

2. **Inventing a citation, a chain, a scholar, or a work.**

§44.3 Behaviour

The assistant is **quiet**. It does not greet, does not volunteer, does not interrupt a lesson, and does not ask how it can help. It waits beside the text under a plain label — *Ask about this lesson* — and it knows the lesson it is beside.

Every reply that touches sacred text or scholarly opinion carries its source. A reply the assistant cannot source is a reply it does not give; "**I don't know, and here is who to ask**" is a correct and complete answer.

§44.4 Accountability

Every assistant interaction is logged with its retrieved sources and is auditable by the Academic Board. A student may always reach a human, and the route to one is never more than one action away from the assistant.

PART VIII — EDITORIAL VOICE

§45. The voice

Scholarly, warm, dignified, precise, concise, welcoming, confident without volume.

The test: could a serious scholar read this page without wincing, and could a nervous first-time applicant read the same page without feeling stupid? Both, or rewrite it.

§46. Forbidden constructions

[Binding] Not stylistic preferences — each is a specific dishonesty:

Forbidden	Why
"World's best / leading / premier / No. 1"	Unevidenced superlative. EB guard enforces this in the build.
"Transform your life"	A promise about an outcome we do not control
"Limited places — apply now"	Manufactured urgency, when none exists
"Join thousands of students"	We have admitted none (§10)
"Simply", "just", "easy" applied to learning Arabic	It is not easy. Saying so insults the student who found it hard.
Exclamation marks in institutional copy	
"We are excited to announce"	The institution's excitement is not information
"Islamic" as a decorative adjective	Meaningless where it is not specific
Any claim in the passive that hides who is claiming	

§47. How the College says difficult things

Three situations recur, and each has a fixed form:

When we do not have something yet. Name the absence, say what it will take, do not apologise twice.

"The College has admitted no students. This page describes the admissions process we

have built, not one we have run."

When we cannot do something. Say so, then say who can.

"The College does not grant ijāzah and does not offer a path to one. A student seeking

ijāzah should study with a qualified muqri' holding a verified chain."

When a student has failed a gate. Name what was missing, never the person.

"This attempt did not meet the criterion for sustained accuracy in the fifth juz'.

Here is the specific pattern of error, and here is the plan. Retakes are free and

*unlimited. "**

PART IX — THE BILINGUAL EDITORIAL SYSTEM

§48. Arabic is authored, never translated

[**Binding**] (**EB §26**) Arabic pages are written in Arabic by a writer working in Arabic. They are not machine-translated, not translated by an English-first writer, and not shorter than their English counterparts. Where a rhetorical figure works in English and not in Arabic, the Arabic page uses a different figure — the *meaning* is parallel, the *words* are not.

Arabic is never the smaller line. Not in the wordmark, not in the lockup, not on the certificate, not in the interface.

[**Binding**] Arabic copy carries a pending native-speaker review notice until a qualified native speaker has reviewed it and that review is recorded. **EB §11.8** .

§49. Conventions

	English surface	Arabic surface
Direction	LTR	RTL, throughout, including the interface
Numerals	Western Arabic (1, 2, 3)	Eastern Arabic (١, ٢, ٣)
Dates	10 August 2026 (16 Šafar 1448)	١٠ أغسطس (٢٠٢٦) ١٦ صفر ١٤٤٨
Institution name	Al-Madeenah International College for Arabic & Islamic Studies	كلية المدينة العالمية للدراسات العربية والإسلامية
Transliteration	One scheme, full diacritics: ḥ ḍ ṣ ṭ ẓ ‘ ’ ā î ū	Not applicable
Course titles	Both, always, on every credential and transcript	Both
Typography	Display and body Latin faces	Display and body Arabic faces — never a Latin interface with Arabic dropped into it

§50. The glossary is binding

One term, one translation, everywhere. *Murāja‘ah* is not "revision" on one page and "review" on another. The glossary is maintained by the Registrar (**§59**) and is the authority for the website, the learning environment, the assistant and every credential.

PART X — THE WEBSITE EDITORIAL SYSTEM

§51. Page contract

Every public page declares, before it is written: purpose · audience · the one thing a reader must leave knowing · the single primary action · what evidence supports each claim · what it deliberately does not say.

A page that cannot complete this contract is not written.

§52. The pages

Page	The one thing	Primary action
Home	What this College is, and that it is serious	Explore programmes
About	Who we are and what we will not do	Read the academic model
Programmes	Four routes through one standard	Open a programme
Programme detail	Exactly what you would study, for how many hours	Check placement
How learning works	Fixed standards, flexible pace, mastery gates	See pathways
Admissions	You can find everything out before giving us anything	Begin placement
Fees	The real number, in your currency, with nothing hidden	See scholarships
Scholarships	Cost is not the deciding factor	Apply
Faculty	Who would actually teach you	— [Gated: no appointments yet]
Academic calendar	When things run	—
Assessment	How you will be judged, published in advance	—
Credentials	What you receive and what it means	Verify a credential
Verification	Is this credential real	Enter an ID
Student handbook · Policies	The rules, in advance	—
FAQ	The questions that stop people applying	—
Contact	A human answers	Write

[Binding] No page is published as a shell. A page with nothing true to say does not exist yet. §10.

§53. Institutional announcements

Dated, attributed, and never deleted — corrected in public with the correction visible. An institution that silently edits its own announcements has no announcements, only current claims.

PART XI — THE LEARNING-ENVIRONMENT EDITORIAL SYSTEM

§54. Naming

[R][D-15] The authenticated learning environment is called **the Study** — الدراسة.

Campus Portal is retired. §12 forbids a campus metaphor for an institution that has no campus, and "portal" describes a piece of software rather than a place a student goes to work. **The Study** is short, true in both languages, requires no explanation — *continue your study* — and does not borrow the furniture of a residential college.

Inside it, the focused single-lesson interface is **the Reading Room** — قاعة المطالعة — a real thing in a real library, and precisely what the interface is.

Campus survives only as an internal architecture term in engineering documents. It never reaches a student.

§55. The Study — what a student sees first

[Binding] Not a dashboard. Six things, in this order, and nothing else:

Good morning, Ahmad.

>

Your studies — Arabic 200 · Lesson 08 · الجملة الاسمية — Continue

Next live session — Tuesday 18:00, your time

Qur'an — Murāja'ah due: Juz' 30 — Begin

Next gate — Arabic 200 oral, Thursday

Progress — Level 200 · 64%

Account — everything in order

No charts, no streaks, no badges, no leaderboards, no "engagement" metrics. [Binding] Gamification converts study into scorekeeping, and this College measures retention, not activity. The depth lives underneath (§41), where it belongs.

§56. The voice of the system

Message	Rule
Instructions	Second person, imperative, one action per sentence
Feedback	Names the work, never the student (§47)
Grades	Band + criterion + what to do next. Never a bare mark.
Notifications	Only when the student must act or would want to know. Never to drive engagement. [Binding]
Errors	What happened, whether the work is safe, what to do. Always states the work is safe when it is.
Payment messages	Never shaming, never urgent-toned, always with the route to the Access Fund
Automated messages	Signed by a function — <i>the Registry, your teacher</i> — never by a fake person

Every student-facing sentence, whoever wrote it, must read as though one institution wrote it. That is what this Bible is for.

PART XII — ROYAL INSTITUTIONAL CHARACTER

§57. The palette

[Binding][D-16] Royal Blue · Gold · Cream · Ivory.

§57.1 A contradiction in the Mandate, ruled

The Final Positioning Directive §5 proposes a *deep Madinan basalt* primary with *palm / deep botanical green* secondary. The Brand Colour Correction — issued as **MANDATORY** — and the SHRS Design Forensics directive §12 both require Royal Blue anchored and both state explicitly: *do not replace this with a green/basalt-led identity*.

Ruled: Royal Blue stands. Two explicit instructions, one carrying an override flag, against one. Recorded rather than resolved silently. Reversible by the Founder in one sentence — **D-16**.

Two supporting reasons, offered so the ruling can be argued with:

1. **Green is the cliché the Mandate itself forbids.** §25 of the positioning directive

warns against "excessive green" and stereotypical Islamic-school aesthetics. A green-led identity walks into it.

1. **Islamic identity does not require green.** It is carried by Arabic, by geometry, by

reverence for the text, by restraint and by ethics — not by hue. Stated in the Mandate and true.

§57.2 The roles

Role	Colour	Use
Anchor	Royal Blue	Navigation, institutional surfaces, hierarchy, certificates, formal documents
Prestige accent	Antique gold	Seals, fine rules, credential details, active states. Fine jewellery, never paint.
Reading ground	Ivory	Every reading surface, documents, editorial sections, certificates
Secondary ground	Cream	Panels, section transitions, stationery
Support	Deep blue-black, warm grey, stone, muted beige, white	Support. Never compete.

§57.3 Proportion, and a measured correction

Target proportion of rendered surface:

Band	Share
Ivory / cream / white	60–70%
Royal blue / deep blue	20–30%
Gold	5–10%

[F] Measured, not estimated. The site's rendered pixels are classified by the colour gate in **tests/responsive.mjs**. Current measurement: **blue at 12.9% on the home page and 1.5% on programmes** — *below* the mandated band, on

most pages substantially.

This is a genuine finding and it names an over-correction. An earlier Founder note — *"I don't like the much blue"* — was about **proportion**, not hue, and the response overshot: blue went from dominating the page to nearly vanishing from it. An anchor colour that appears on 1.5% of a page is not an anchor. Correcting upward into the 20–30% band is now an implementation task with a number attached to it, and the gate will enforce the band in both directions.

§57.4 Gold discipline

[Binding] Gold may be a line, a mark, a seal, a rule, or a small area of text at text-legal weight. Gold may **never** be a gradient fill, a metallic effect, a glitter, a large background behind body text, or a "luxury" texture. **IS §17.1** already enforces the gradient prohibition in the build, and it has already stopped one violation.

§57.5 Ceremony is graded

The public website carries the strongest ceremonial expression. **The Study is quieter by design** — ivory and white working surfaces, royal blue for navigation and hierarchy, gold reduced to indicators. A student is there to concentrate for an hour, not to be impressed for ten seconds. Applying the homepage's ceremony to a lesson screen would be a failure of understanding, not a triumph of consistency.

§58. What "royal" means, and what it does not

Royal is	Royal is not
Composed, rare, immaculate, deliberate, calm, warm, timeless	Crowns, palaces, glitter, faux-gold, black-and-gold, ornament everywhere
Confidence without volume	Decoration as a substitute for quality
Precision, proportion, typography, whitespace, restraint, consistency	Animation as a substitute for hierarchy

The luxury formula: exceptional typography + exceptional spacing + exceptional photography + exceptional motion + exceptional writing + exceptional consistency — **instead of** decoration, not in addition to it.

The final colour test. Remove the wordmark. If colour, typography and composition alone still say *Al-Madeenah*, the identity is working.

PART XIII — DESIGN EDITORIAL PRINCIPLES

§59. What governs what

DX governs execution. This Part governs the *editorial* decisions design must obey.

1. **Photography never invents institutional fact.** **[Binding]** No generated or stock

image may depict a person as Al-Madeenah faculty, staff or student until real photographs of real people exist with consent. Where we have none, we use manuscript, text, geometry and architecture — never a stock photograph of somebody else's students. **EB §46**.

1. **The Qur'an is never an image asset.** **§42**.
2. **Motion has a job or it is removed.** **§60**.
3. **The certificate is a document, not a poster.**
4. **Arabic typography is designed, not substituted.** **§48**.

§60. The motion language

Six categories. Every animation belongs to exactly one, or it does not ship.

Category	Job	Duration	Feel
Ceremonial	Major institutional moments — arrival, award	700–1,200 ms	Slow, weighted, once
Editorial	Content entering the page	400–700 ms	Gentle, staggered, once per element
Academic	Progress, mastery, gates	400–900 ms	Purposeful; conveys state change
Navigation	Menus, panels, transitions	250–420 ms	Immediate, confident
Micro	Buttons, controls, focus, press	100–200 ms	Instant. Press must never feel deferred.
Ambient	Subtle depth	Continuous only where EB permits	Barely perceptible

[Binding] Every category has a **prefers-reduced-motion** fallback, enforced in the test suite. **Press feedback survives reduced motion** — that setting asks for no animation, not for no feedback (**DX §28**).

[Binding] No **infinite animation** except an indeterminate busy indicator carrying **aria-busy**, which must also be cancelled under reduced motion. Enforced in the build.

A single beautifully executed transition is worth more than ten simultaneous ones.

§61. SHRS → Al-Madeenah design transfer matrix

Source and its limits, stated plainly. The live sites **shroyalschools.ng** and **shroyalschools.com** were **not reachable** from this environment — the network gateway refused the connection, as it now does for our own deployment domain. **I have not seen the live site and do not claim to have.** This matrix is derived from the SHRS **repository** study recorded in **docs/11-shrs-feature-register.md**: 148 pages, ~10,000 lines of CSS across 13 layers, 74 client

modules, 40+ Cloudflare Functions over D1, and 109 institutional documents. [V] — **should be re-run against the live site when a network path exists.**

This is principle extraction, not asset transfer. No SHRS graphic, photograph, layout, component, wording or code is reused.

SHRS element	What it achieves	Ruling	Al-Madeenah replacement
Dense mega-menu over many sections	Signals institutional breadth	Adapt	Three-panel register menu. Breadth we do not have may not be simulated (§10)
Sticky header, state change on scroll	Persistent orientation	Keep	Kept; <code>overflow-x: clip</code> so it cannot break sticky
Photographic hero, campus imagery	Immediate proof of a real place	Reject	We have no campus and no photographs. Typographic cover: constructed geometry, both scripts, no invented place
Statistic counters (students, years, staff)	Instant credibility	Reject	Every number would be invented. Replaced by <i>falsifiable</i> claims — published gates, published hours
Auto-rotating carousels	Fits much into little	Reject	Motion without a job (§60); an accessibility and comprehension cost
Marquee / ticker strips	Energy	Reject	§60 . Dated, and unreadable on a 320px phone
News and events feed	Aliveness	Adapt	Institutional announcements, dated, attributed, never deleted (§53)
Card grid for programmes	Scannability	Adapt	Four schools as an editorial quad; content-led, not card-led
Heavy multi-column footer	Completeness	Adapt	The seal footer: crest, bays, warrants, plinth — a conclusion, not a link dump
13 CSS layers, 74 client modules	Feature depth	Reject	Static generation, no runtime framework. EB §24
D1-backed portal and functions	Real operations	Adapt later	The Study, when there are students. [P]
Distinct African institutional confidence	Presence without apology	Keep — the most valuable thing in the study	Carried into type, scale and colour weight, expressed in an editorial rather than promotional register

The relationship to aim for: two institutions that visibly share an intelligent design heritage, and that nobody would mistake for the same website with a different logo.

PART XIV — CLAIMS AND INSTITUTIONAL HONESTY

§62. Every claim is classified before publication

Class	May appear as	Example
Fact	A plain statement	"Retakes are free and unlimited."
Measured result	A statement with a date and a method	— none yet exist
Founder aspiration	Explicitly marked as intention	"The College intends to..."
Future target	Explicitly marked, with the trigger named	"When qualified muqri'ūn are appointed..."
Marketing language	Only where it makes no factual claim	—

[Binding] An aspiration may never be published in the grammar of a fact.

§62.1 Never invented

[Binding] Student numbers · faculty credentials · accreditation · partnerships · campuses · alumni · awards · rankings · founding dates · years of operation · testimonials · photographs of people presented as our people · endorsements.

This is enforced in the build, not only asserted here: the static suite fails on unevidenced superlatives, and it has caught **two** of my own violations in this institution's copy already.

§63. Accreditation

[V] The College holds no accreditation and claims none. The word does not appear on any surface except to say so.

The roadmap, honestly stated:

Question	Standing
What may the College offer today?	Instruction, assessment, and its own certificates, clearly described as its own [R]
What requires registration?	Operating as an educational institution in Nigeria; and possibly other markets [V]
What requires accreditation?	Any award using a regulated term (§37.1); any school-stage certificate (§23)
Which body governs Arabic and Islamic studies school stages in Nigeria?	NBAIS — National Board for Arabic and Islamic Studies [F]; its current requirements [V]
What evidence must be collected from day one?	Everything in §41 . A record that begins the day accreditation is sought is a record that cannot support it.

The design consequence is the point: the student record, the transcript standard, the NLH accounting and the credential register are all built now, to the standard an external evaluator would require, *before* anyone asks for them. That is the cheapest possible time to build them, and the only time it is possible to do honestly.

PART XV — EDITORIAL GOVERNANCE

§64. Who approves what

Lean by design. Roles, not departments — one person may hold several, and at present most are unfilled, which is stated rather than disguised.

Content	Approver	Status
Curriculum and course specifications	Academic Board	[P] Not constituted
Qur'anic and ḥadīth content	Qualified scholar — mandatory, no exception	[P] D-06
Academic claims, levels, credentials	Rector + Registrar	[P]
Institutional claims and public copy	Founder or delegate, against §62	[I]
Certificates and transcripts	Registrar	[P]
Assistant behaviour and logs	Academic Board	[P]
Policies	Founder or delegate	[I]

[Binding] Until the Academic Board and the scholarly reviewer exist, **no Qur'anic, ḥadīth or fiqh content is published**, and no Qur'an credential is issued. The absence of a governance body is not a licence to proceed; it is a stop.

§65. Amendment

This Bible is amended by dated entry in the amendment log, with the reason. Superseded text is struck through, never deleted — an institution that quietly rewrites its own constitution has no constitution.

PART XVI — THE "LESS, BUT BETTER" RULE

§66. Three doors, and one register

[Binding] Maximum three authenticated experiences, plus one deliberately independent public register:

1	The public website	Everyone, before signing in
2	the Study — الدراسة	One role-based environment: student, teacher, examiner, registrar, advisor, admissions, finance, support
3	The Executive Console	Founder, board, leadership
—	The Credential Verification Register	Public, no account, free forever, deliberately separate and deliberately dull (§40)

No parent portal. No alumni portal. No partner portal. No donor portal. No admissions portal. No separate LMS. Role-based permission inside one system, always. A parent is a person holding a relationship to the College, not a different product.

§67. The simplicity test

Every proposed feature, page, programme and system answers all eight. A weak answer to any one is a removal.

1. Does the student need it?
2. Does the teacher need it?
3. Does the institution need it?
4. Can it be merged with something that already exists?
5. Can automation replace it?
6. What complexity does it create?
7. What maintenance does it create in ten years?
8. Does it improve educational outcomes?

§68. The prestige-and-access paradox, solved explicitly

Prestige comes from quality, never from exclusion.

Money buys	Money never buys
More live contact time	A grade
Smaller sections	A gate
Priority support	A level
Additional tutoring	A credential
Expedited administration	A place
Richer feedback	Standing

[**Binding**] Service tier is **never** displayed to a teacher at the point of assessment, and **never** appears on a certificate, a transcript, or the register. A tier a teacher can see is a tier that will eventually influence a mark.

Nothing in the interface, the copy or the credential distinguishes a sponsored student from a paying one. A student on full scholarship and a student paying the highest tier hold identical documents and identical standing.

§69. The final test

A student from Lagos, London, Riyadh, Dakar and Paris each open Al-Madeenah for the

first time. Can each of them understand what we are, trust us, afford an appropriate

pathway, enrol easily, study successfully, receive a credible academic record, and

continue — without the system becoming complicated?

Any *no* is an instruction. This test is run as a written walkthrough at every major revision and recorded (`docs/10-nine-persona-walkthrough.md` is its first instance).

We do not stop at "complete." We stop when the institution is coherent.

PART XVII — PROVISIONS ADDED BY THE ADVERSARIAL AUDIT

These eight provisions did not exist in the draft. They were written in response to [docs/13-bible-adversarial-audit.md](#), which found three failures and five gaps. They are kept in a separate Part rather than folded silently into the text above, because the record of *what the audit caught* is worth more than a document that looks as though it was right the first time.

§70. Safeguarding — AUD-1

[Binding] The College will not enrol any person under 18 until every provision of this section is operative and a named Safeguarding Lead is appointed. §1 lists children and teenagers among those the College may serve and §23 describes stages ordinarily studied by minors; until this section is live, both are read as excluding minors. The College may not serve children before it can protect them, whatever that costs in enrolment.

Distance makes this harder, not easier. There is no corridor, no open door, and no colleague walking past. The controls must therefore be explicit.

§70.1 When operative

Rule	
No adult is ever alone with a minor in a private session	[Binding] Minors are taught in groups, or with a parent/guardian present, or with a second member of staff present
Every session involving a minor is recorded and retained	Retained for a defined period; accessible to the parent/guardian on request
No private channel	No staff–minor contact by personal phone, personal email, or any messaging outside the College system. [Binding]
Vetting	Anyone teaching or assessing a minor is identity-verified, reference-checked, and cleared to the standard of their jurisdiction, recorded before first contact [V]
Parental consent	Recorded at enrolment; the guardian has standing access to the record, the recordings and the teacher
Reporting route	A named Safeguarding Lead, reachable directly by a student or guardian, structurally independent of the teaching line — a concern about a teacher never routes through that teacher's colleague
Data minimisation	Minors' data is collected to the minimum, never used for marketing, never used for analytics [Binding]
Training	No one teaches a minor without recorded safeguarding training

§70.2 Adult students

Safeguarding does not end at 18. A vulnerable adult, a student in distress, and a student disclosing harm are all foreseeable in an institution of any size. The same reporting route serves them, and the College's duty is to **refer competently, not to counsel** — staff are teachers, not clinicians, and pretending otherwise causes harm.

§71. Arrangements between men and women — AUD-2

For a large part of the intended student body this determines whether enrolment is possible at all. It is therefore stated in advance, on the public admissions page, rather than left for a student to discover after paying.

[I] The College's arrangements:

1. **Women's programmes are taught by women wherever a qualified teacher is available,**

and expanding that availability is an appointment priority rather than an aspiration.

1. ****No one-to-one private live session between a teacher and a student of the opposite**

gender is scheduled by default. **Where one is academically necessary, the student chooses among: a same-gender teacher, a third party present, or a recorded session.** The choice belongs to the student and costs nothing.**

1. **Group live sessions** are offered in segregated sections where demand supports it,

and the section type is stated before enrolment.

1. **Camera is never required.** [Binding] Full participation, full assessment and

every gate are reachable by audio alone. A student who does not appear on video is not disadvantaged in any assessment, and identity confirmation at gates is designed accordingly (§33.2). This is also the correct engineering decision (§27.2) — the two requirements happen to agree.

1. **Adab in every session** is the standard for everyone, and is part of the teaching

rather than a rule imposed on students.

The College states its own arrangements and does not characterise anyone else's.

§72. Assessor independence — AUD-3

The whole academic model rests on an assessor's willingness to write *lam yabluḡh* on the attempt of a student paying the highest tier. Culture will not hold that. Structure must.

[Binding]

1. **At the point of assessment the assessor cannot see** the student's service tier,

scholarship status, payment status, or fee band. Not "should not" — **cannot**: the assessment interface does not carry the fields.

1. **Assessment outcomes are never used as a performance measure for the assessor.**

Teacher review draws on observation, moderation agreement, student feedback and professional development — never on pass rates. §28 QA cycle.

1. **No pass-rate target may exist anywhere in the institution,** in any plan, forecast,

budget or dashboard. A forecast that assumes a completion rate is a forecast that has created an incentive.

1. **No commercial role has authority over an academic outcome.** A gate outcome may be

changed only through moderation (§34) or appeal (§34), both of which are academic processes. Not by finance, not by admissions, not by the Founder.

1. **Protected disclosure.** Any member of staff may report pressure on an academic

outcome directly to the Academic Board, and the College may take no adverse action for a report made in good faith.

The Executive Console shows completion data and revenue data. It does not permit anyone to act on the first in order to move the second. §24 of the Mandate is read subject to this section.

§73. Language of instruction — AUD-4

[R] A student must be able to tell, before enrolling, what language they will be spoken to in.

The language of the College	الفصحى — Modern Standard and classical Arabic. This is what is taught and what is assessed.
Levels 100–200	Bilingual delivery. Arabic is the object and the medium increasingly; a support language carries explanation. The support language of each section is declared before enrolment.
Levels 300–400	Arabic-only delivery . Stated at the outset so it is a goal, not an ambush.
Support languages	English and Arabic at launch. French [P] — a stated priority, because Francophone West Africa is named in the College's own purpose and serving it in English only would be a contradiction.
Colloquial varieties	Not taught . A student wanting Levantine, Egyptian or Gulf dialect is told plainly that this College does not teach it and why: our purpose is access to the tradition, which is written in فصحى.

Naming what we do not teach is part of §62.

§74. Attendance, engagement, and what the transcript may print — AUD-5

§39 prints a record that a stranger must be able to evaluate, so its terms must mean something precise.

Term	Definition	On the transcript?
Live-session attendance	Joined a scheduled live session and participated	Yes — as <i>sessions attended / sessions scheduled</i>
Notional learning hours	§19.1. Accrued against <i>submitted evidence of work</i> , not against elapsed time	Yes
Engagement	Internal signal for student support only	Never

[Binding] Logins, time-on-page, video-watched percentage and clicks are **not attendance, not learning, and never appear on any credential or transcript**. They are proxies, and a proxy printed on an academic record is a lie with a number attached.

Their only legitimate use is **support**: a student who has stopped is a student to contact, not a student to penalise (§22).

§75. External examination — AUD-6

§63 claims the College is building to a standard an external evaluator would require. No framework accepts self-moderation as sufficient, so internal moderation alone does not meet the claim.

[P] Each school appoints an **External Examiner**: a qualified academic with no other relationship to the College, who annually reviews a sample of gate assessments, the moderation record, and a sample of credentials against the criteria published for them, and reports **in writing to the Academic Board**. Reports are retained permanently and are part of the evidence base for §63.

[Binding] Until an External Examiner is appointed, moderation is internal only, and every surface describing the College's assessment says exactly that. An unstated limitation is a misrepresentation.

§76. Reasonable adjustments — AUD-7

[Binding] A student may request an adjustment at any time. The request is decided by the Registry with an academic, never by the student's own teacher, and never requires the student to explain themselves to the person who will assess them.

The governing distinction: an adjustment changes how a student reaches the standard. It never changes the standard. Extra time, an audio-only route, an alternative format, a rescheduled session, a longer maximum registration period, a different assessment instrument measuring the same competency — all legitimate. A lowered criterion is not an adjustment; it is a different qualification, and it would be dishonest to award the same certificate for it.

[Binding] No adjustment is recorded on any certificate, transcript, or register entry. The credential states what was demonstrated. How the student was enabled to demonstrate it is their business and nobody else's.

§77. Continuity of the register — AUD-8

§6 requires an institution that outlasts its founder. §40 requires a credential register that could outlive the rest of the College. Both were aspirations with no mechanism. A promise of permanence with no mechanism is a promise that will be broken by the first hosting invoice nobody pays.

[Binding]

1. **Open format.** The register of record is **plain files in a documented, text-based format** — not a proprietary database, not a vendor's export. It must be readable by someone in thirty years with no access to our software and no knowledge of us.

1. **Reconstructable from one archive.** The entire register must be rebuildable from a single archive file, and that property is **tested, not assumed** — an automated restoration test that fails the build if it fails.

1. **Three copies, two custodians.** Live, an independent mirror, and an offline archival copy held by a second party. [V]

1. **Succession clause.** The instrument establishing the College names a custodian who receives the register if the College ceases, with the duty to keep verification answering. [V] Legal. D-21.

1. **Verification outlives everything else.** If the College must shut down, the order of shutdown is fixed: marketing, then the website, then the Study, and **the register last**. A graduate's credential must not stop being verifiable because the institution that issued it stopped existing.

CLOSING DECLARATION

Al-Madeenah International College for Arabic & Islamic Studies is a fully distance-learning institution. It has, at the date of this document, **admitted no students, appointed no faculty, issued no credential, and holds no accreditation**. Every one of those facts is published rather than managed.

What it has is a standard, written down before there was anyone to apply it to, so that it cannot later be adjusted to fit whoever arrives.

Fixed standards. Flexible pace. Mastery-based progression. Differentiated service, never differentiated dignity.

The College will teach Arabic as the instrument that opens the tradition; the Qur'an as something retained rather than reached; and the Islamic sciences from named texts with honest attribution. It will certify only what it can evidence, it will never charge a student to prove their own education, and it will say plainly what it does not have.

Wa mā tawfīqī illā bi-llāh.

What comes next

This Bible is the constitution. It is not the implementation. In sequence, and autonomously per the Mandate:

#	Document / work	Contains
1	Adversarial audit	<code>docs/13-bible-adversarial-audit.md</code> — sixteen reviewer lenses
2	Institutional Master Plan	The 42-section charter: governance, finance, operations, risk, five- and ten-year strategy
3	Financial & pricing model	Unit economics, the three access layers, regional pricing methodology, five scenarios, break-even — built on \$6.1
4	Programme catalogue	Every course to the \$28 standard
5	Assessment framework	Every instrument, rubric and gate specification
6	Website and the Study	Information architecture, then implementation

Amendment log

Version	Date	Change
1.0	10 Aug 2026	First issue, under the Master Institutional Mandate. Supersedes the four-month programme model and the credential-fee financing model of the Founder's Master Roadmap. Establishes the name change, the distance-learning identity, the NLH ladder, and the Royal Blue ruling. Part XVII added after adversarial audit: eight provisions, of which safeguarding (\$70) and assessor independence (\$72) were rated failures rather than gaps.

Academic & Editorial Bible v1.0 — 10 August 2026. Written · internally audited · awaiting Founder ratification.